

By JASPREET BINDRA

HARNESSING INDIA'S **AI POWER**

THE COUNTRY STANDS POISED TO LEVERAGE AI'S TRANSFORMATIVE POTENTIAL THROUGH AGENTS, APPLICATIONS, LITERACY AND SAFETY

IT **has been two years since OpenAI released ChatGPT into the wild**, racking up the fastest-ever 200 million users, setting off a feeding frenzy in the tech world, and heralding the inevitable Age of AI. As 2025 dawns and the technology takes its baby steps into some kind of maturity, I believe there will be four megatrends that will drive AI to shape business and society in India and across the world.

Apps to Agents: If 2023 was the year of ChatGPT, and 2024 was the year when multiple Large Language Models (LLMs) like Claude and Gemini bloomed into existence, 2025 will be the year of AI Agents, or Agentic AI. A prescient Bill Gates blog foresaw this in 2023. "In the next five years," he wrote, "...you'll simply tell your device, in everyday language, what you want to do...and software will be able to respond personally because it will have a rich understanding of your life. This type of software—something that responds to natural language and can accomplish many different tasks based on its knowledge of the user—is called an agent." "Agents are not only going to change how everyone interacts with computers," he went on to say, "they're also going to upend the software industry." Instead of tapping a few apps multiple times or asking ChatGPT a series of questions to work out a complex and frustrating travel itinerary, what if, say, a Booking.com agent would select a hotel and airline we usually prefer, design a day-to-day schedule based on our interests, and go ahead and book the tickets and hotels, after we have given it the permission and the agency to do so. Agentic AI will bring Generative AI to the enterprise, with AI bundling up discrete steps in a typical enterprise workflow into an AI agent software, replacing traditional Software-as-a-service into the new SaaS: Service-as-a-software. Bain Capital's Sarah Hinkfuss elegantly describes it: "We are used

THE NEW AGENTIC AI WOULD DESIGN A DAY-TO-DAY TRAVEL **SCHEDULE BASED ON OUR INTERESTS, AND BOOK THE TICKETS AND HOTELS.** THIS WOULD REVOLUTIONISE PERSONAL TASKS